

MHA PIB Public Advisory on Fraudulent Job Offers and Illegal Predatory Loan Apps

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Official Advisory: Press Information Bureau & MHA: Alert Against Online Job and Loan App Fraud

Part-Time Work-from-Home and Task Scams

Fraudsters reach out via WhatsApp/Telegram offering lucrative part-time work involving 'YouTube video liking', 'hotel reviews', or 'cryptocurrency rating'. Victims are paid small amounts (■150 to ■500) initially to build trust, then induced to join VIP tasks requiring security deposits of ■10,000 to ■5,00,000. Once large funds are deposited, withdrawals are blocked and handlers disappear.

Predatory Unregulated Instant Loan Apps

Illegal digital lending apps advertise instant loan approvals with zero documentation. Upon download, these apps demand invasive access to contacts, SMS history, and photo galleries. Once installed, exorbitant interest rates (up to 200%) and hidden processing fees are levied. If payments are delayed, recovery agents morph victims' private photos and blackmail family contacts.

Safeguards and Consumer Advisories

1. Legitimate employers NEVER charge registration fees, training deposits, or task participation funds.
2. Only borrow from RBI-registered Banks and NBFCs. Verify the lender name on the official RBI list of registered NBFCs.
3. Never grant contact list, media storage, or gallery permissions to financial or utility applications.
4. Report predatory loan harassment to 1930 and Sanchar Saathi Chakshu portal immediately.

Do Not Yield to Coercion

Victims of loan app blackmail should immediately file complaints on cybercrime.gov.in and refrain from transferring extortion money.

Citizen Action Checklist & Red Flags

- **Verify Sender Identity:** Always check official website addresses and header IDs (e.g., VM-SBI, AX-HDFC). Scammers use fake sender masks.
- **Never Share Authentication Secrets:** Passwords, OTPs, UPI PINs, and debit card CVVs are strictly confidential. Bank staff will NEVER ask for them.
- **Independent Verification:** If you receive a threat or alert about an account freeze, call the official bank branch number found on your physical card or bank statement.
- **Immediate Reporting:** Report cyber financial fraud within the Golden Hour by calling 1930 or visiting cybercrime.gov.in.

Frequently Asked Questions (Regulatory Clarifications)

Q1: Can money be deposited into my bank account by entering my UPI PIN?

A: No. A UPI PIN is solely an authorization to debit funds from your linked bank account. Receiving funds requires NO authentication or PIN entry.

Q2: What is the first action to take if money is fraudulently deducted?

A: Dial 1930 immediately to register the complaint on the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) CFCFRMS portal so that the beneficiary account can be frozen before funds are withdrawn.

Q3: What should I do if an unknown caller threatens me with a police arrest over video call?

A: Disconnect immediately. Indian police and law enforcement agencies never issue summons, conduct investigations, or

place citizens under 'Digital Arrest' via video calls.

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